

# Catering and Dining Payment Guide

*SJSU Main Campus (Not Student Union)*

*This guide specifies appropriate payment methods and requirements for catering on and off-campus dining.*

**Catering** is the provision of food and drink at a social event or other gathering as a professional service.

**Dining** is the act of going to a restaurant or establishment to partake in food or drink.

**Please note:** Catering in the Student Union may have special catering requirements. Please contact the [Student Union](#) directly for inquiries.

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# Responsibilities

## Chartwells/Compass Group/Spartan Eats

### Spartan Eats

[Spartan Eats](#) is the front-facing platform used to order catering services at SJSU. Chartwells is our **primary and preferred caterer** for SJSU and works through the Spartan Eats platform.

### Chartwells

SJSU has partnered with Chartwells for Catering Services which means Spartan Eats is our preferred caterer.

**Ordering:** Chartwells receives order requests for catering services from the department through [Spartan Eats Portal](#) or by phone at 408-924-1756.

**Payment:** Spartan Eats online orders can be paid with a credit card or the department can reference a chartfield when submitting an order request ([See Catering Payment Matrix](#)). If the department wishes to have the services paid via chartfield, then Chartwells will submit an invoice to the department once the event has completed.

**Invoicing to Departments:** Invoices that have not been submitted to Payment Services for payment by the department will be submitted directly to Payment Services for processing after 90 days and will pay without a department's approval.

### Compass Group

Compass Group is the primary name for Chartwells. Compass Group is the name used in FTS when submitting invoices to Payment Services utilizing the Direct Pay option.

### Department

Each department is responsible for making catering requests via Chartwells first before looking for alternative caterers. The department is also responsible for making sure their catering invoices are paid in full, this means either by paying with a credit card or submitting a chartfield during the ordering process via Spartan Eats Portal. Departments are responsible for submitting invoices via Direct Pay if not paid by credit card. If the invoice is not submitted in a timely manner, Chartwells will direct the invoice to Payment Services who will then process the invoice for payment without approval.

*(Note: If there are any catering changes that may have taken place during your event and the invoice was not reconciled and corrected within a week of the event, Payment Services will pay the invoice in full without adjustments when the invoice becomes overdue by 90 days. This is why it is imperative the department review the invoices as soon as possible and submit them for payment to Payment Services to be processed).*

## Payment Services

Payment Services is responsible for processing invoices for payment for catering services. Invoices over \$5k submitted as a Direct Pay will be processed via the Payment Services ProCard. Invoices from Chartwells submitted to departments but not submitted to Payment Services will not be paid, however, Chartwells will re-direct invoices to Payment Services and will be processed for payment via the chartfield given by the department.

*(Note: If there are any catering changes that may have taken place during your event and the invoice was not reconciled and corrected within a week of the event, Payment Services will pay the invoice in full without adjustments. This is why it is imperative the department review the invoices as soon as possible and submit them for payment to Payment Services to be processed).*

## Individual/Employee

Employees are **NOT** allowed to have catering shipped to a home address.

## Catering Guideline

SJSU requires insurance documentation and health certificates from all caterers that provide on-campus catering services. For this reason, all caterers must be pre-approved by SJSU. When purchasing catering, refer to the SJSU [Catering Policy](#).

## Hospitality Guideline

- When purchasing catering, refer to the [SJSU Hospitality Guidelines](#)
- All catering purchases require a [Hospitality Expense Justification Form](#) unless specified otherwise. See also [Important Key Points](#)

## What is not considered Catering

Prepackaged foods and snacks are not considered catering and do not need to follow the [“How to get a quote”](#) process below, however, they still require a [Hospitality Expense Justification Form](#) because it is food-related. Reference the [Prepackaged Foods and Snacks definitions](#) in this guide.

## How to make a Catering request

If you have an event coming up, please submit a request within **10 days** of your event via the link below:

Please be aware that Spartan Eats has the first right of refusal for catering requests. To utilize an alternative caterer, a request must demonstrate a concerted effort to utilize Spartan Eats first. Submitting your current budget and providing sufficient time for Spartan Eats to review each catering request **is required**. Spartan Eats will provide a written communication if they are not able to accommodate your request.

If a request is submitted **under 10 days**, additional approval from Commercial Services will be required. Please contact [Zeltzin Islas Barron](#) for approval.

## Ordering

Chartwells has several portals for catering:

- [Spartan Eats](#)
- [Spartan Eats Custom Request Form](#)

Chartwells can be [flexible](#) with food choices, services, and budget limitations in order to meet the needs of your event. Please be sure to provide key information as listed in the follow section.

## How to get a Quote

Complete your event request through the [Spartan Eats Portal](#). You will receive confirmation from the catering team in several hours. If there is follow-up information needed, the catering team will reach out directly to the department.

### Things to consider for your catered event by Spartan Eats:

Spartan Eats does a great deal of customized events (i.e. sit-down dinners, special menus, special events). There is the option to request a special quote, in which case the [catering team](#) will contact you and ask for:

- Date & Time
- Budget (either per person or for the event as a whole)
- Attendance number
- Menu, either pre-existing (Spartan Eats) or custom
- Dietary needs
- Special rental needs: tables, bars, equipment, linens, flatware, service ware
- Labor requests (staffed service, bartenders, etc.)
- Format: plated, buffet, contactless
- Special event requests: DJ, etc.
- Professional needs: chefs, chef station, teaching kitchen
- Other high-level items (floral arrangements, colors, music, etc)

### Payment Options (also refer to [Catering Matrix](#)):

1. ProCard can be used for all Online orders under \$5k.
2. Over \$5k, a Direct Pay if invoice is submitted immediately after the catered event. All Online orders not paid by ProCard will **require** a chartfield submitted during the ordering process.
3. After a Chartwells invoice is past 90 days old, and has yet to be submitted to Payment Services, Chartwells will submit the invoice to Payment Services which will process the invoice for payment using the chartfield provided by the department to Chartwells.

# Pre-authorized Caterers On-Campus Businesses

All businesses on the campus have been vetted by Spartan Eats and can be used as an alternative caterer, no quote or first right of refusal is required from Spartan Eats. (Ex. Subway, Starbucks, Nirvana Soul, Panda Express, etc)

## Can I use other options for Catering besides Spartan Eats?

Yes, however, you need to ensure that you have the 1st right of refusal from Spartan Eats prior to selecting an alternative caterer. See the options listed below.

### Alternative Caterer List

Alternative Caterer are listed here on our [Secondary Catering List](#).

### Alternative Caterer

If Spartan Eats or its affiliates cannot accommodate the needs of your request, then an alternative caterer is an acceptable option only after the following criteria has been met:

1. Spartan Eats Quote has been obtained by Chartwells. This quote does not meet the timeline, needs, or budget limitations of your event. This quote must be submitted with your Requisition, Direct Pay, or Employee Reimbursement request. See [How to get a quote](#)
2. Spartan Eats communication (email, or other documentation) explaining they are not able to meet the needs for your event at this time.
3. Caterer must be fully approved by Strategic Sourcing - Contracts & Procurement Services, based on meeting our Liability Insurance<sup>1</sup> & Health Permit<sup>2</sup> requirements and maintaining a current status on said requirements.

See *Example 1 from the Secondary Caterer List* below. See also [Food Trucks](#) for additional information.

### Example 1

4th Street Pizza is fully approved, however, Casa Vicky is not due to the expired Liability Insurance. 4th Street Pizza is an approved caterer. **Casa Vicky is NOT approved.**

| Caterer          | Category/Cuisine | Phone #      | Contact Person  | Email Address/Online Catering | Address                                     | Liability Insurance Expires | Health Permit Expires |
|------------------|------------------|--------------|-----------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------|
| 4th Street Pizza | American, Pizza  | 408-286-7500 | Josh Mchle      | 4thstpizza@gmail.com          | 150 E Santa Clara St,<br>San Jose, CA 95113 | 5/26/2022                   | 7/31/2022             |
| Café Rosalena    | Mexican          | 408-859-2242 | Linda Buchanan  | lindacaferosalena@gmail.com   | 1077 The Alameda,<br>San Jose, CA 95126     | 6/1/2022                    | 12/31/2022            |
| Casa Vicky       | Mexican          | 408-995-5488 | Marie A Aguilar | casavicky@hotmail.com         | 792 E Julian St.,<br>San Jose, CA 95112     | 1/29/2022                   | 3/31/2022             |

<sup>1</sup> SJSU requires insurance documentation from all caterers that provide on-campus catering services to ensure the restaurant has liability insurance coverage. Liability insurance coverage is to protect the University from any injuries or property damage when a caterer comes onto our campus.

<sup>2</sup> Santa Clara County Department of Environmental Health (DEH) works to safeguard public health and ensure food provided to consumers is safe, unadulterated, and honestly presented, by regulating the food sold or distributed to the public. Santa Clara County Department of Environmental Health (DEH) works to safeguard public health and ensure food provided to consumers is safe, unadulterated, and honestly presented, by regulating the food sold or distributed to the public.

If you wish to hire an alternative caterer (other than Spartan Eats that is not listed on the Secondary Caterer List (aka Master Caterer List) for a campus event, please contact [Strategic Sourcing - Contracts and Procurement Services](#).

Please email [catering@sjsu.edu](mailto:catering@sjsu.edu) as well, or get approval to use the alternative caterer by having the vendor complete the following [Catering Application](#) (obtaining the required documentation (Liability Insurance & Health Permit) and submitting to [catering@sjsu.edu](mailto:catering@sjsu.edu) and/or [Strategic Sourcing - Contracts and Procurement Services](#).

### **Food Trucks - require special approvals and authorizations**

Food Trucks require additional safety measures especially to protect SJSU from legal issues when coming onto campus property. Please be sure to contact FD&O for authorization to bring onto the campus. Cindy Soto at 408-924-1950.

## Having a Special Event?

Please check out the forms and information listed below:

- [Special / Outdoor Event Requests webpage](#) [FD&O]
- [FD&O for Special Event Approvals](#) [FD&O]
- [Special Event Liability Insurance Request Form](#) [Risk]
- [Special Event Release Agreement Form](#) [Risk]

## Documentation Requirements

### Spartan Eats is your Caterer:

Please include the following when submitting payment requests.

1. Itemized invoice/receipt
2. [Hospitality Expense Justification](#)
3. Agenda (for employee ONLY meetings/events only)

For Requisitions, include a price quote/estimate in lieu of the invoice/receipt.

### Approved Caterer from [Secondary Caterer List](#) (aka Master Caterer List):

Please include the following when submitting payment requests.

1. Spartan Eats Quote or email communication explaining why they could not provide catering for your department event, budgetary limitations, or other reasons your department needs could not be met. (Please ensure you exhaust all efforts to use Spartan Eats before using an alternative caterer).
2. Itemized invoice/receipt

3. [Hospitality Expense Justification](#)
4. Agenda (for employee ONLY meetings/events only)

For Requisitions, include a price quote/estimate in lieu of the invoice/receipt.

## Catering Payment Matrix

| Meal Expenses                                 | Location   | Procard          | Direct Payment  | Requisition        | Employee/Student Reimbursement |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------|------------------|-----------------|--------------------|--------------------------------|
| Spartan Eats (Under \$5k)                     | On Campus  | Yes              | No <sup>1</sup> | No                 | Yes                            |
| Spartan Eats (Over \$5k)                      | On Campus  | No               | Yes             | No                 | No                             |
| <a href="#">Approved Caterer (Under \$5k)</a> | On Campus  | Yes <sup>2</sup> | No              | No                 | No                             |
| <a href="#">Approved Caterer (Over \$5k)</a>  | On Campus  | No               | No              | Yes <sup>2</sup>   | No                             |
| <a href="#">Approved Caterer (Under \$5k)</a> | Off Campus | Yes              | No              | No                 | No                             |
| <a href="#">Approved Caterer (Over \$5k)</a>  | Off Campus | No               | No              | Yes <sup>2,5</sup> | No                             |
| Dining Out** (Under \$5k)                     | Off Campus | Yes              | No              | Yes                | Yes <sup>4</sup>               |
| Dining Out** (Over \$5k)                      | Off Campus | No               | No              | Yes <sup>3</sup>   | No                             |

<sup>1</sup> Spartan Eats under \$5k are allowed only if the department does not have a ProCard.

<sup>2</sup> Approved Caterer over \$5k: a Spartan Eats price quote/estimate is required or email communication from their office for not meeting your needs. If “Off-Campus Catering”, location is key to whether a Spartan Eats quote is required or not and must follow Approved [Secondary Caterer List](#). (NOTE: if the vendor does not exist in FTS, please use **“Supplier Credit Card Only”** as the option or Supplier to Bid if no credit cards are involved)

<sup>3</sup> Dining Out (Over \$5k): a Spartan Eats price quote/estimate is required or email communication from their office for not meeting your needs.

<sup>4</sup> Dining Out (Under \$5k): Employee reimbursement limit is \$1k. Special approval will be needed for anything over \$1k.

<sup>5</sup> Off-Campus Catering (Over \$5k): If a contract is involved, only an authorized SJSU representative with a Delegation of Authority can sign. Contact [Contracts & Procurement Services](#).

\*\* While Dining Out is not considered catering, it is represented here due to the relation to Hospitality and Food purchases.

## Additional Information

### Important things to consider

- SJSU requires insurance documentation and health certificates from all caterers that provide on-campus catering services.
- Per the [Hospitality Guidelines](#) the expense must serve a bona fide business purpose.
- Alcohol is not allowed for purchase using state funds. It could only be paid using Auxiliary funds.
- Preparing food for consumption is not allowed unless you have taken the food handling course. Contact [Risk Management](#) for more information. Food Handling course can also be found in [CSULearn](#).
- NCAA-related meals are not governed by this guide.
- Food and beverages purchased for a course/class supplies are not governed by this guide.
- Employees are not allowed to have catering shipped to a HOME address.
- Student Union has their own special requirements for catering in their building, please contact them directly for information.

### Definitions

**Dining/Dining Out:** Dining refers to dining out which involves off-campus eating. See also Off-Campus Dining.

**Food Handling Course:** This course is designed for those handling raw foods or prepping foods. It teaches employees temperature controls, washing, and prep techniques. Anyone can access this course so long as they have access to [CSU Learn](#) of course.

**Food Pickup:** Food picked up by an employee and brought to campus is still considered catering.  
*Example: Picking up a pizza from Pizza My Heart to bring to a meeting with students.*

**Homemade Food:** Food created at an employee's home and brought into the office for students. This method is still considered catering and is not allowed unless you have taken the food handling course. For more information, please contact [Risk Management](#) or look for the [Food Safety and Handling](#) course in CSULearn.

*Note: Employees who bring in food for their own personal use with and for other employees are allowed as long as no reimbursement is being requested and the employee is doing it of their own accord and does not involve students.*

**Off-Campus Catering:** Catering refers to meals and light refreshments that have been prepared off-campus and consumed at a location that is not on campus. (Occurrence is Rare)

**Off-Campus Dining:** Off-campus dining refers to meals and light refreshments consumed off campus.



**On-Campus Catering:** Catering refers to meals and light refreshments that have been prepared and consumed on campus.

**Prepackaged Foods:** Packaged in a container in the manner in which the food is originally sold, typically by a grocery store is not considered Catering. Made-to-order foods (aka Prepared Foods) are not considered pre-packaged foods. (Examples include bakery items and deli orders)

**Prepared Foods:** Foods that are typically produced for immediate consumption by an individual or a vendor/store. Must follow the [Secondary Catering List Rules and Process](#). If prepared personally by an individual (such as an employee baking a cake or making sandwiches), please refer to Homemade Foods.

**Snacks:** Prepackaged foods. According to the Hospitality Guide, this is considered a light meal or refreshment.

## Food Handling Course Details:

The CSULearn [Food Safety and Handling](#) course is available for those who plan to handle food that will be provided to students. *Example: Homemade foods*

After completing the course, forward the certificate of completion to Risk Management at [risk-management-group@sjsu.edu](mailto:risk-management-group@sjsu.edu).

### CSULearn Food Safety and Handling Course Description

Each year, bacteria in food cause millions of illnesses in the US. According to the Food and Drug Administration, between 2% and 3% of all foodborne illnesses result in secondary long-term illnesses. Some strains of E. coli can cause kidney failure in infants, and salmonella can lead to reactive arthritis and serious infections. In addition to the risks from badly prepared or mishandled food, there is the potential risk of malicious contamination.

Those involved in food preparation must follow safe procedures to ensure that food contamination and its associated illnesses are prevented. This course focuses on the health risks associated with improperly handled food. It highlights the ways in which food can become contaminated and provides guidelines for storing and handling food safely. By applying the procedures recommended in this course, you can minimize the risk of food-related illnesses.

The course was developed and reviewed with subject matter support provided by certified subject matter experts and industry professionals.

Please note, the course materials and content were current with the laws and regulations at the time of the last expert review, however, they may not reflect the most current legal developments. Nothing herein, or in the course materials, shall be construed as professional advice as to any particular situation with respect to compliance with legal statutes or requirements.

## FAQs

**Q:** What reason would my Catering Application be rejected?

**A:** If the vendor is unable to provide the required documentation for insurance or health certifications.

**Q:** Can I have my Procard limit increased if my total is over \$5,000 for my catered event?

**A:** No, if your order is over \$5,000, please submit a requisition.

**Q:** Can I use my favorite restaurant for my event?

**A:** No, you cannot use a vendor that is not listed on the Secondary Catering List (aka Master Caterer List). This is in order to ensure we have the proper documentation to keep SJSU legally safe.

**Q:** I want to make some homemade food for my meeting.

**A:** This is not recommended, however, if you have taken the Food Handling Course listed in this guide, this would allow for this solution to your request and then be allowable but still not recommended for safety and legal issues involving food.

**Q:** I want to have catering at the Student Union. Is there anything I should know about having catering at their building?

**A:** Yes, Student Union building has special requirements but you will need to contact them directly for their dedicated catering list and insurance requirements.